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Classroom Assignment Sheet

Assignment Code

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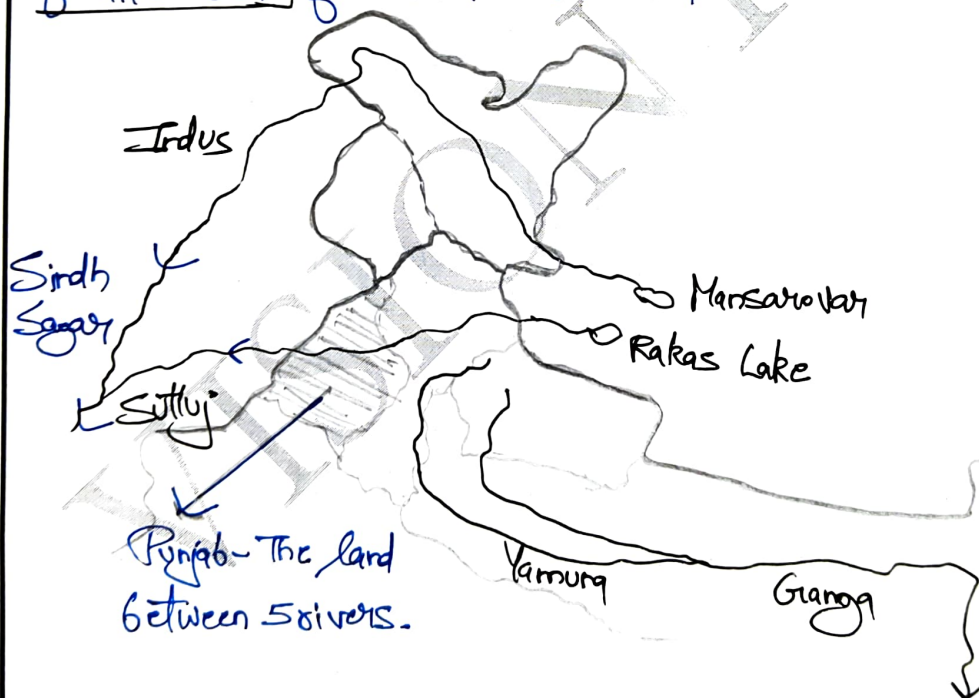
Name:

JAYANT KUMAR

Subject: M.H. Batch: RR33 Submission Date: 25/7/2026

Total
Marks

Question - Discuss the objectives behind the introduction of Mahalwari Settlement & how it affected peasant livelihoods and revenue generation for British authorities? On the pretext of "accommodating diverse agricultural practices across various regions in British India", the Mahalwari Settlement aimed to extract the max. revenue from what British considered as the most fertile belt of India - North and Northwest.



Qualitative map representing the fertile Indo-Gangetic plains from where British collected max. revenue by imposing a higher tax slab.

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Objectives - To save administrative cost of revenue collection.

1) Community driven approach - The revenue collection contracts were signed by village headmen and Lambardars.

2) Accomodate diverse agricultural practices across various regions in India.

3) Varying rate of taxes were imposed which depended upon agricultural and market conditions.

4) Promote cashcrops to support industrial revolution in Britain.

5) Maintain land records by land surveys which aimed at measurement, creation of landmap (Khasra).

Impact on peasant livelihoods

1) Exorbitant tax assessments - Flawed land surveys led to high & heavy tax assessments which ~~per~~ burdened the peasants with indebtedness and sale of their land to zamindars or moneylenders, eventually leading to land alienation.

2) Commodification of land - Land became a marketable asset which could be sold and purchased like any other commodity. This market was facilitated by Lambardars and British officials.

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Evaluation
Feedback:
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	Context	Content	Structure - presentation	Language	Word limit	Overall performance
Excellent						
Good						
Average						

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Question—

Revenue generation by British authority.

- 1) This was the most exploitative land revenue system in British India with varying rate of taxes upto 75% in some cases, resulting in a high revenue collection.
 - 2) As planned, the British authority collected more rate of tax from regions of high agricultural productivity.
 - 3) By involving intermediaries — Lambardars, British saved a lot on the cost of revenue collection.
- Thus, the exploitative revenue collection policies of British led to a widespread resentment among peasants which culminated in the sepoys mutiny of 1857 & most of these sepoys were "peasants in uniform".